- If price moves sideways (often for weeks or months), the trade is more likely to fail.

Table 44.11 shows special features of horn tops.

Spike height performance. I determined the height of the spike from the lower of the two horn spikes to the higher of the adjacent three weeks (week before the left horn spike, middle week, and week after the right horn spike). I compared that height to the average spike height for the stock over the prior year. For those horn spikes shorter than their average, the median performance in bull markets was a drop of 16%. Spikes taller than their average showed losses of 15%. For those patterns with horn spikes at least twice the average height, they performed even worse, as the table shows.

The taller the spike the worse the performance.

Price difference. I looked at the price difference between the two highs in the horn top and compared it to the median for all horn tops. When there was a large price variation (above the median 1%), the horn performed better after the breakout. So look for horns with uneven tops.

Table 44.11 Special Features

Description	**Bull Market**	**Bear Market**
Spike height shorter than average, median performance	–16%	–23%
Spike height taller than average, median performance	–15%	–22%
Spike height twice the average, median performance	–14%	–18%
Median horn difference as percentage of breakout price	1%	1%
Difference > median, median performance	–20%	–28%
Difference <= median, median performance	–17%	–25%